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Why Pandoc does not retrieve the image file?

What are you?

- a.  Rockstar c.  Guru
b.  Ninja d.  None of the above



On RStudio version 0.98.501 I had a long .Rmd file which was easily converted to html once I clicked KnitHtml button. The Knitting process, as I understand, created several folders including images (some manually added by myself), figures, cache and a knitrHtml folder which included final .html file. I recently downloaded RStudio version 0.98.894 (preview release) because I wanted to use more features. Now, when I click knitrHtml I get following error:

```
pandoc.exe: Failed to retrieve C:/Users/durraniu/Documents/Trajectory1/images/vissim-view.png
InvalidUrlException "C:/Users/durraniu/Documents/Trajectory1/images/vissim-view.png"
"Invalid scheme" Error: pandoc document conversion failed with error 61
```

I copied all the images including the `vissim-view.png` as indicated above, from the images folder to the knitrHtml folder and clicked the button again. This time it gave the same error related to image file which R would create i.e a plot. I don't know how to resolve this. Please help.

knitr rstudio pandoc rmarkdown

asked Jun 6 '14 at 22:49

 umair durrani
1,002 6 22

Never use absolute paths unless you absolutely have to. Use relative paths whenever you can. Put your image under the same directory as the Rmd file, and use ``. – Yihui Jun 7 '14 at 5:52

1 Pandoc on Windows is not great at handling paths. If you want, you can revert to 0.98.501's KnitToHTML behavior by adding the comment `<!-- rmarkdown v1 -->` to your document. See [Migrating from RMarkdown V1](#). – Jonathan Jun 7 '14 at 13:12

1 @Jonathan Thanks for the suggestion. I wanted to use rmarkdown version 2 to add table of contents. It seems to me now, after Yihui's comment, that it is almost impossible to knit a Rmd file created on an older version of RStudio in a new version. I either have to change the paths of all images or be content without table of contents. By the way, thank you Yihui I will keep this in my mind to not use absolute paths next time. – umair durrani Jun 7 '14 at 16:36

@umairdurrani If a relative path works, please write it as the answer and mark it as accepted (you are welcome to answer your own question on SO). – Yihui Jun 8 '14 at 5:34

@Yihui Changing to relative paths worked perfectly, it created table of contents and displayed all figures. However after some time I clicked knitrHtml again to make sure `cache=TRUE` was working but got the following error with no output: `pandoc.exe: Could not find data file ./Trajectory1-new_files/figure-html/pdf_velocity.png Error: pandoc document conversion failed with error 97`. Please note that I copied all the images to the same directory where Rmd file resides. I don't know if its me or a bug in preview release of RStudio. – umair durrani Jun 9 '14 at 18:45

3 Answers

I encountered a similar error like this: `pandoc.exe: Could not find data file ProjectPart1_files/figure-html/sample_Mean_versus_Theoretical_Mean-1.png Error: pandoc document conversion failed with error 97`

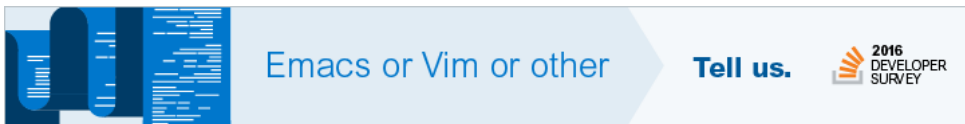
And one sentence from this page http://rmarkdown.rstudio.com/authoring_rcodechunks.html solved my problem.

"If you run into problems with cached output you can always clear the knitr cache by removing the folder named with a `_cache` suffix within your document's directory."

When the error occurred, there exactly existed a folder with name like "ProjectPart1_cache" in the working directory. After I deleted it, the error was removed.

answered Jul 9 '15 at 16:16

 Tom
104 1 2 8



Sadly, Jonathan's answer in the comments worked for me. I added:

```
<!-- rmarkdown v1 -->
```

To my document, and it did the trick. He claims that this is because Pandoc on Windows is not great at handling paths.

If someone else would write a better answer, I will gladly erase this one.

edited Aug 14 '14 at 22:55



[Peter O.](#)

14.3k 7 43 58

answered Aug 14 '14 at 21:38



[Tal Galili](#)

6,447 13 73 119

I would recommend using latest version of R Studio and using relative paths. That's how I am doing it now.

– [umair durrani](#) Aug 19 '14 at 17:19

Any updates on this? I'm new with RStudio (and the related tooling) and I'm having the same error. –

[Lucas Soares](#) Nov 4 '14 at 12:58

While there are multiple correct solutions above, I'd like to add that a common cause of this error is syntactical, when the author accidentally wraps the file name in the markdown in quotes:

```
![my_image]("my_image.png")
```

This will result in pandoc being unable to locate the file. I find this mistake to be easy to make in knitr, since we are intertwining R scripts with markdown.

The correct way to insert the image is:

```
![my_image](my_image.png)
```

answered Jan 19 at 20:15



[Megatron](#)

657 3 9 23